BEACON OF LIBERTY

INTRODUCTION

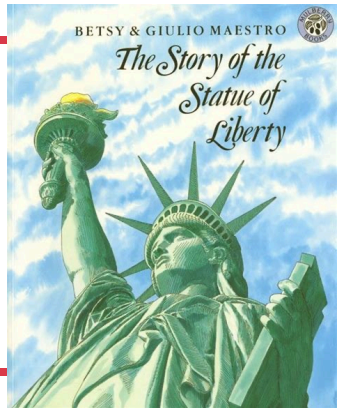
After our flag, the Statue of Liberty is the second most evocative symbol of the United States of America. Our history as a nation is all about the struggle to provide increasing liberty to more of our citizens. From our earliest beginnings we saw ourselves as a "shining city on a hill," a beacon of liberty for other nations to emulate. *Liberty Enlightening the World*, holding her torch aloft and welcoming immigrants to America, is the physical manifestation of that ideal.

For many years Liberty and her torch served as the focal point for immigrants seeking their fortune in the New World, coming to America for a better life for themselves and their families, pursuing the American Dream. They left the oppressions of their old life behind for the freedoms, the opportunities, and the liberty that America offered.

The Statue of Liberty was a gift from the French people to the American people to mark our shared love of liberty. The French people paid for the statue itself while Americans paid for the pedestal the statue stood on. Over 120,000 people in the United States donated funds for the pedestal with 80% of them donating less than a dollar — a great example of widespread American generosity, our devotion to Liberty, and the friendship between two peoples who share the same ideals.

BOOK

Title: *The Story of the Statue of Liberty*
Author: Betsy Maestro
Illustrator: Giulio Maestro
Year Published: 1989
Length: 48 pages



Activity	Time	Frequency	Preparation
American Heritage Songbook: *America (My Country 'Tis of Thee)*	5 minutes	daily	minimal
Arts & Crafts: Make Your Own Statue of Liberty	10-20 minutes	once	minimal
Geography: America & France	15 minutes	once	minimal
Famous American Texts: *The New Colossus*	5-10 minutes	daily	minimal
Cooking: Apple Pie	30-35 minutes + baking	once	15 minutes + shopping
Science: Oxidation	20 minutes	once	10 minutes
Science: Take a Virtual Tour	10-15 minutes	once	minimal

Re-enactment: Be Bartholdi or Be Lady Liberty	20 minutes	once	30 minutes
Supplemental Reading: *Liberty's Journey*	10 minutes	once	minimal
Supplemental Reading: *Her Right Foot*	10 minutes	once	minimal
Scripture: Matthew 5:14-16	10 minutes	once	minimal
Vocabulary	10 minutes	once	minimal
Writing: Dear Lady Liberty	10-20 minutes	once	minimal
History: Symbolism	10 minutes	once	minimal
Civic Culture: Generosity	10 minutes	once	minimal
Games: Transporting Statue of Liberty	10-20 minutes	once	minimal

Below is one suggestion for your week with the book *The Story of the Statue of Liberty*. Please experiment with what works for your family! (Note: not all activities are included in the suggested sample week below).

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Arts & Crafts: Make Your Own Statue of Liberty	Geography: America & France	Vocabulary (before reading)	Re-enactment: Be Bartholdi or Be Lady Liberty	Civic Culture: Generosity
American Heritage Songbook: *America (My Country 'Tis of Thee)*	Famous American Texts: *The New Colossus*	Science: Oxidation	Supplemental Reading: *Liberty's Journey*	History: Symbolism
Supplies: toilet paper rolls, card stock, tissue paper, pen, paint, paint brush, glue, scissors	**Supplies:** U.S. Puzzle, Globe	**Supplies:** Pennies, Bowl, Vinegar, Salt, Towel	**Supplies:** Play-doh, Sheet, Flashlight, Headband, Foil	**Supplies:** N/A

AMERICAN HERITAGE SONGBOOK: AMERICA (MY COUNTRY 'TIS OF THEE)

Samuel Francis Smith wrote the lyrics to *America* when he was a seminary student in 1831. He used the melody from the British national anthem, *God Save the Queen*. The song was a strong contender for the national anthem of the United States of America but, in 1931, Congress chose the *Star-Spangled Banner* instead.

The song's opening lyrics celebrate America as the "sweet land of liberty" with the first verse ending with the uplifting call to "let freedom ring!"

My country 'tis of thee
Sweet land of liberty
Of thee I sing
Land where my fathers died;
Land of the pilgrims' pride
From ev'ry mountainside
Let Freedom Ring!

The last verse evokes America's deep religious culture as well as Smith's theological background as it calls on God's protection and blessing:

Our fathers' God to thee,
Author of Liberty,
To Thee we sing.
Long may our land be bright,
With freedom's Holy light,
Protect us by Thy might,
Great God, our King.

The Mormon Tabernacle Choir sings it with lyrics set against wonderful images of America here. Kelly Clarkson's 2013 version, with lyrics and images, is here. Marian Anderson, a famous contralto, was denied permission to sing in front of an integrated audience by the Daughters of the American Revolution. Instead, Eleanor Roosevelt arranged for her to sing *America* to a crowd of 75,000 in front of the Lincoln Memorial on Easter Sunday, 1939. Millions more heard her perform live on the radio. Finally, an elegant version of the first verse was arranged by Michael Hedges and sung by David Crosby & Graham Nash immediately after 9/11.

ARTS & CRAFTS: MAKE YOUR OWN STATUE OF LIBERTY

The Statue of Liberty stands on an island in New York Harbor. She is a beautiful sight to all who pass by her.

Because the Statue of Liberty is such an important symbol of American ideals, we have two craft activities for this module: Toilet Paper Roll Statue of Liberty and Liberty's Crown and Torch.

Toilet Paper Roll Statue of Liberty (h/t A Little Pinch of Perfect).

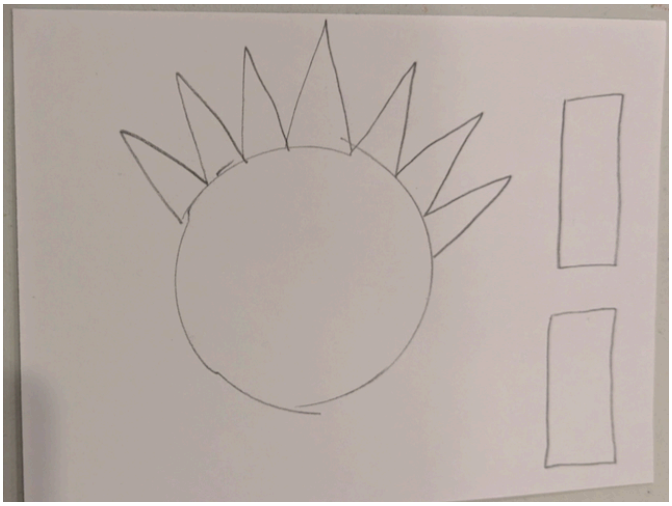
Supplies:

- Toilet paper roll
- White cardstock
- Red and/or orange tissue paper (or card stock)
- Pen

- Paint brush
- Scissors
- Green and white paint (we used acrylic)
- Glue (we used both a glue stick and hot glue)

Directions:

1. Draw a circle on the cardstock with seven triangles around half of the edge of the circle. The circle should be a little bigger than the toilet paper roll. Draw two small rectangles as well to make the torch and tablet. See photo.



2. Mix paint until it is the correct shade of green for the Statue of Liberty. Alternatively color brown for the pre-oxidized version.

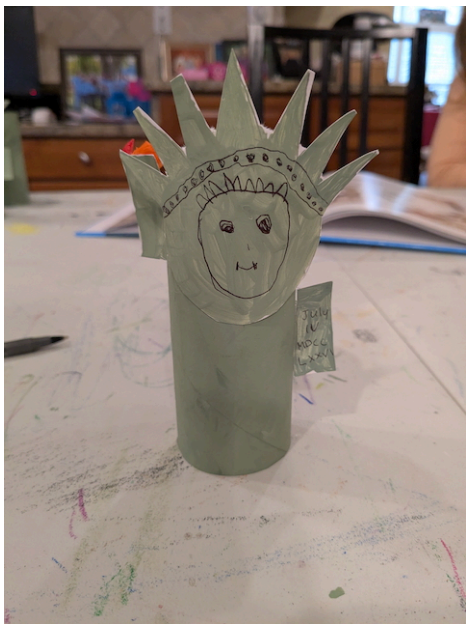
3. Paint the spikey circle, two rectangles and toilet paper roll with the green-ish paint. Allow to dry.

4. Draw a face over the (dry) paint in the circle part. Alternatively add additional details like windows in the crown or dates on the tablet.

5. Cut the circle with spikes and the two rectangles out of the card stock with scissors.

6. Cut (very) small pieces of tissue paper out and glue them to the top of one of the rectangles.

7. Glue head at the top of the toilet paper roll. Glue tablet on one side and torch on the other a little higher. See photo.



Liberty's Crown and Torch (h/t Buggy and Buddy)

Supplies:

- White paper plate
- White paper bowl or cup
- Paper towel roll
- Cardstock (red and orange or white and use paint to make them red/orange)
- Scissors
- Stapler
- Green/white paint
- Bobby pins or hole punch and string

Directions:

1. Cut the middle out of the paper plate. Cut about a third out of the the circumference of the plate. Cut seven triangles out of the middle of the plate. See photo below.
2. Cut a circle out of the middle of the bottom of the bowl (or cup) the same size (or just smaller) than the size of the paper towel roll.
3. Mix paint until it is the correct shade of green for the Statue of Liberty. Alternatively color brown for the pre-oxidized version.
4. Paint the seven triangles, the rim of the plate, the bowl (or cup), and the paper towel roll green. Allow to dry.
5. Once dry, staple the seven triangles onto the rim. Wear as crown and secure in place with bobby pins or punch holes in the sides and secure with string.



5. Slide the bowl (or cup) onto the paper towel roll until there is about 1-2 inches of roll above the bowl (or cup).
6. Cut flame shapes out of the cardstock (about four shapes).



7. Cut twice as many slits in the top of the paper towel roll as flame shapes (so about eight). These should be in the part of the paper towel roll above/in the bowl (or cup).
8. Fold the flame shapes in half and then slide each one into adjacent slits on the paper towel roll to make a torch.



GEOGRAPHY: AMERICA & FRANCE

Bartholdi had created many other statues and monuments, but this one was to be very special. It was to be a present from the people of France to the people of America, as a remembrance of the old friendship between the two countries.

When the Statue of Liberty was unveiled in New York's harbor in 1886, the United States had grown to 38 states. Colorado was the most recent, joining the union in 1876. The 12 twelve territories yet to become states were: North Dakota (1889), South Dakota (1889), Montana (1889), Washington (1889), Idaho (1890), Wyoming (1890), Utah (1896), Oklahoma (1907), New Mexico (1912), Arizona (1912), Alaska (1959), Hawaii (1959).

Take your jigsaw puzzle map of the United States and remove all the states that have not yet joined the union. Alternatively, take a map of the United States and color in the states that are part of the Union. Label the sheet "1886."

The country of France played a crucial role in America's War of Independence from Great Britain. At that time, France was also at war with Great Britain so it made strategic sense for them to ally with America. America returned the favor in World War I ("Lafayette, we are here!") and World War II, helping to liberate France from German invasions.

However, the gift of the Statue of Liberty from the people of France to the people of America had no such geopolitical strategic goals. In fact, the project was initiated by private individuals, (Frederic Bartholdi, Edouard de Laboulaye), just to express their love of liberty and the friendship between two peoples in honor of America's centennial.

Locate France on a globe and show your child(ren) how the Statue of Liberty had to be transported across the Atlantic Ocean in order to reach its destination in New York.

FAMOUS AMERICAN TEXTS: THE NEW COLOSSUS

Not like the brazen giant of Greek fame,
With conquering limbs astride from land to land;
Here at our sea-washed, sunset gates shall stand
A mighty woman with a torch, whose flame
Is the imprisoned lightning, and her name
Mother of Exiles. From her beacon-hand
Glows world-wide welcome; her mild eyes command
The air-bridged harbor that twin cities frame.

"Keep ancient lands, your storied pomp!" cries she
With silent lips. ***"Give me your tired, your poor,***
Your huddled masses yearning to breathe free,
The wretched refuse of your teeming shore.
Send these, the homeless, tempest-tost to me,
I lift my lamp beside the golden door!"

As part of the fundraising effort to erect the pedestal for *Liberty Enlightening the World*, Emma Lazurus wrote a sonnet called *The New Colossus* (the "Old Colossus" was the Colossus of Rhodes, one of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World). The poem was published in both Joseph Pulitzer's *New York World* and the *New York Times*, initially enjoying wide popularity. Lazarus died the year after the Statue of Liberty was erected and the poem faded from popular memory until a friend of hers rescued it from obscurity in 1901. The poem is now inscribed on a plaque mounted on the pedestal.

Lazarus's poem celebrates Liberty as the "Mother of Exiles," a symbol of hope for immigrants seeking a new opportunity. The most famous line has Liberty saying, "Give me your tired, your poor, your huddled masses yearning to breathe free."

Read the poem to your child(ren). Point out to them the rhyme scheme and how it starts out "ABBA" but changes at the end to "CDCDCD" when Liberty starts speaking.

Ask them to memorize the famous line from the poem, in bold above. Practice each day after reading the story to them.

COOKING: APPLE PIE

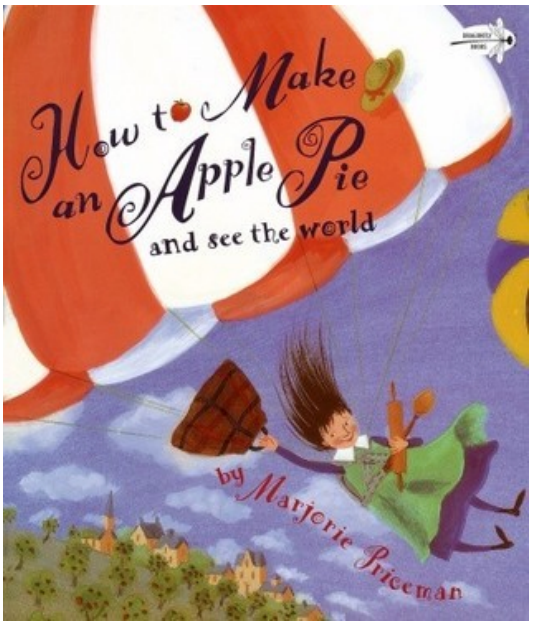
At last, in 1886, Liberty was standing where she
belonged. A wonderful celebration was held.

The Statue of Liberty is one of the preeminent symbols of the United States of America. Even though it originated in France, we think of it "as American as apple pie." Interestingly enough, apple pie also has its origins in old Europe. In fact, apple trees are not native to America and had to be imported from Europe.



So, how did apple pie come to symbolize something that was typically American or patriotic? It started in 1796 when *American Cookery*, the very first American cookbook, was published. It contained two recipes for apple pies. Apple pie became a dish with widespread popularity throughout America. The expression “as American as apple pie” was first used in the 1800s but became much more widely used after World War II, when American soldiers, when asked what they were fighting for, answered “for Mom and apple pie.”

Apropos the European origin of the apple pie and America’s propensity for borrowing many of our cultural elements, the recipe below comes from the picture book *How to Make an Apple Pie and See the World* by Marjorie Priceman.



You can make your own pie crust (yes, there is a recipe in the story for pie crust also). But the simpler method we used was to purchase a two-pack of frozen pie crusts.

Ingredients:

- 5-7 apples
- 3/4 cup sugar
- 1 teaspoon cinnamon
- 1/4 teaspoon salt
- 2 tablespoons butter

Directions:

1. Preheat oven to 425 degrees
2. In a large bowl, mix together sugar, cinnamon, and salt.
3. Peel, core, and cut apples into 1/2 inch slices.
4. Toss the apples into the sugar mixture, coating them well.
5. Arrange the apple slices in the pie pan, piling them higher in the center.
6. Dot with butter.
7. Moisten the edge of the bottom crust with water.
8. Cover the pie with the top crust, trim the edge, then pinch top and bottom edges together.
9. Cut some vents in the top crust.
10. To glaze the crust, mix an egg yolk with 1 tablespoon of water. Brush the mixture over the surface of the top crust.

11. Bake 45 minutes or until apples are tender and crust is golden brown.
12. Remove pie and allow to cool before serving.

SCIENCE: OXIDATION

> *Then, a skin of gleaming copper was put onto the skeleton and held in place by iron straps. As the huge statue grew, all of Paris watched with great fascination.*

Both *The Story of the Statue of Liberty* and *Her Right Foot* describe how the Statue of Liberty is made from copper and started out brown, gradually changing to the bluish-green color we know today after decades of oxidation. Her copper covering is approximately the width of two pennies, which leads to our science demonstration. We will speed up the process of oxidation and turn a brown penny bluish-green in just a couple of hours. The chemical reaction below is similar to but not exactly the same as what happened to the Statue of Liberty.

For this demonstration you will need:

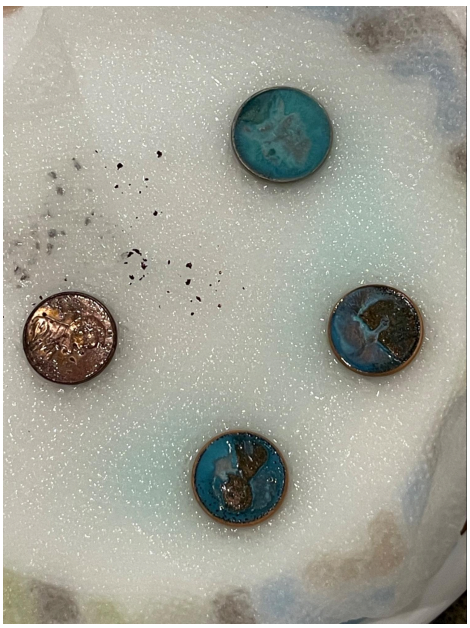
Supplies:

- Pennies
- Vinegar
- Salt
- Paper towels
- Bowls

Directions:

1. Pour vinegar into one bowl and water into a second bowl. Add salt to the bowl with vinegar.
2. Place pennies into both bowls. Observe what happens. (The pennies in the vinegar should turn nice and shiny. The pennies in water remain unchanged).
3. Remove the pennies. Fold a paper towel into quarters and then soak it in the vinegar/salt solution. Place your pennies on top of the paper towel. With exposure to the oxygen in the air, your young scientists should start to see the pennies turning bluish-green in a couple of hours – this is oxidation! (You may need to re-moisten the paper towel with your vinegar/salt solution periodically to keep the reaction going.)

As an additional control, we included nickels with the pennies. We thought we would demonstrate the difference between copper and nickel. Our expectation was that the nickel would not be oxidized. To our surprise, we learned that nickels are actually made up of 75% copper. It oxidized and turned bluish-green just as readily as the pennies. Ah, the serendipity of science :-)

The nickel is in the 12 o'clock position in both photos.

SCIENCE: VIRTUAL TOUR OF STATUE INTERIOR

First, a huge skeleton was constructed from strong steel.

The Statue of Liberty is an engineering marvel. Alexandre Gustave Eiffel, the man who later built the Eiffel Tour, developed her internal skeleton which supports the weight of her tons of copper sheathing. You can see some of this in person if you can visit the Statue of Liberty in New York. But much of the internal structure is not open to the public. The National Park Service created a fascinating virtual tour that shows many of the internals of the Statue of Liberty (as well as the externals). You start at the top, Liberty's Torch!

RE-ENACTMENT: BE BARTHOLDI OR BE LADY LIBERTY

Many people worked together in a large workshop. Some worked on Liberty's head and crown. Others worked on her right hand which would hold the torch.

Be Bartholdi:

Frederic Auguste Bartholdi created multiple models of *Liberty Enlightening the World* before deciding on the version we know today. Using brown and/or green Play-Doh or modeling clay, create your own miniature model of Lady Liberty. You can either imitate Bartholdi's final version or create your own. Once Lady Liberty is complete, place her in a special location or room you can call "France."

Next, your children will need to build a pedestal in "America" for Lady Liberty to stand on. You can use the modeling clay (or Play-Doh) for the pedestal. When it is completed, find a special place, perhaps near your front door, that you can call "Liberty Island."

Finally, Lady Liberty needs to be transported from “France” and across the “Atlantic Ocean” to her pedestal on “Liberty Island” where she can greet newcomers to “America.” Once transported, arrange for a final unveiling ceremony for a parent or extended family members.



Be Lady Liberty:

This activity was fairly spontaneous and turned into a huge hit with the kids. One of their aunts suggested including more dress-up and costumes as part of the activities. As we were just about to launch this module, we challenged her to put together a Statue of Liberty outfit and do the first reading in it. As you can see below, she rose to the challenge with the help of a sheet, a flashlight, a book and a handmade crown (feel free to use the crown and torch from the Arts & Crafts activity!). (Yes, to our surprise, we actually owned a bluish-green sheet that worked perfectly; however, a brown, pre-oxidation sheet, would have worked just as nicely :-) The kids loved it and afterwards both wanted to dress up as Liberty (tip: use the lightweight torch created in the Arts & Crafts activity instead of a flashlight).

Similarly to “Be Bartholdi,” you can have Lady Liberty move from France to a pedestal (chair or step stool) in America.





Lady Libertys On Their Pedestals (Post-oxidation and Pre-oxidation)!

SUPPLEMENTAL READING: LIBERTY'S JOURNEY

But one day, Lady Liberty
wished that she could roam and see
the people who had come and gone;
the land they built their dreams upon.



Title: *Liberty's Journey*
Author: Kelly DiPucchio
Illustrator: Richard Egielski
Year Published: 2004
Length: 40 pages

The Story of the Statue of Liberty provides a great history of how the Statue of Liberty was built, from the inspiration, the fundraising, the transport, to its dedication in New York Harbor. *Liberty's Journey* is a fun supplement, telling the story of how Liberty decides to explore our great country by going for a walk from sea to shining sea (and back again, once she received the letter begging her to return from the people of New York). We used this as a springboard to discuss fact vs. fiction, comparing the two stories. Our three-year-old enjoyed the discussion and was able to distinguish between the two.

SUPPLEMENTAL READING: HER RIGHT FOOT

But no one talks about the fact that she is walking! This 150-foot woman is on the go!



Title: *Her Right Foot*
Author: Dave Eggers
Illustrator: Shawn Harris
Year Published: 2017
Length: 112 pages

Her Right Foot is another great (non-fiction) story about the Statue of Liberty. Dave Eggers recounts the history of the Statue of Liberty. But he then goes on to point out something about Liberty that very few people notice: her right foot is clearly in mid-stride. Liberty is on the move!

Both of these supplemental stories emphasize the fact that liberty doesn't stand still. This is an opportunity to discuss with your child(ren) how liberty is something that takes effort to keep and extend – and sometimes we have to fight to defend her.

SCRIPTURE: MATTHEW 5:14-16

> *You are the light of the world. A town built on a hill cannot be hidden. Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven.*

The Statue of Liberty, with her torch held high welcoming immigrants to America, evokes the enduring theme of "America is a shining city on a hill, whose beacon light guides freedom-loving people everywhere," as President Ronald Reagan described us. President John F. Kennedy made a similar allusion before Reagan, as have many other politicians from both major parties. You can trace this back to John Winthrop, who wrote in 1630, "For we must consider that we shall be as a city on a hill, the eyes of all shall be upon us," as he travelled to the New World as part of the Puritan Hegira.

Just as the Statue of Liberty is "enlightening" the world, we are called upon to enlighten the world with the Word of God. The Biblical scripture that inspired Winthrop was most probably from Jesus' Sermon on the Mount in Matthew 5:14-16. Share this scripture with your child(ren); consider using it as an alternate (or additional!) memorization exercise to the line from the Lazurus poem.

VOCABULARY

Bartholdi himself unveiled Liberty's face and she
stood, gleaming in all her glory, for everyone to see.

The author uses a number of words associated with erecting a gigantic statue that your child(ren) may not be familiar with: skeleton, copper, pedestal, unveiled, immigrants. Try introducing a couple of new words each day. Before you start reading, introduce the words you've selected for the day, define them, and then point them out during the reading.

Skeleton	a supporting framework for a building, ship, statue, or body
Copper	a reddish-brown metal that is easy to shape
Pedestal	a supporting structure or base
Unveiled	revealed; remove a covering like a curtain from a work of art
Immigrants	people who move to another country
Tablet	a flat surface with words inscribed or carved on it
Enlighten	to instruct or teach
Symbol	an object that represents something immaterial (examples: courage, love, liberty)

WRITING: DEAR LADY LIBERTY

"Excuse me," said a boy in blue.
"This mail arrived, addressed to you."
Inside his heavy canvas sack
were cards and letters: "Please come back!"

For this activity, ask your children to write a letter to Lady Liberty, similarly to the events in *Liberty's Journey* quoted above. But unlike *Liberty's Journey*, where New Yorkers ask Lady Liberty to return home, they will be asking her to visit their town or home. The letter should give reasons why Lady Liberty should visit; perhaps explain why liberty is important to them or why Lady Liberty should join them for Show 'n' Tell.

Be creative and have fun with this. You can also write a letter from Lady Liberty's perspective. Our daughters put their letters from Lady Liberty in our mailbox and then went out to "get the mail" and "discovered" the letters to them. One of them actually put together a back and forth correspondence.

HISTORY: SYMBOLISM

The Statue of Liberty is a truly unforgettable sight – a symbol of all that is America.



Liberty was one of the most popular symbols of America long before the Statue of Liberty was conceived. All of our coins not only had the word Liberty inscribed on them but also featured a figure of Liberty herself up until the Lincoln penny was introduced in 1909. Show your children some old coins (or pictures of old coins) to illustrate how far back this symbolism goes. Then show them pictures of the new bullion coins that were introduced in 1986 that revived some of the best Liberty coinage designs of the past.









Extend the exercise by asking your child(ren) to think of words that symbolize your own family. How would you symbolize those? Coat of Arms? Ask them to draw pictures of the symbols for your family.

Ask them if there are any other important symbols of the United States? (The American flag can be found in *Long May She Wave*, the Liberty Bell in *The Fourth of July Story* and the Bald Eagle in *Moonshot*.) Can they think of any other important symbols? Ask them what the cross symbolizes to Christians.

CIVIC CULTURE: GENEROSITY

With the help of a large New York newspaper, the money was raised.
People all over the country, including children, sent in whatever they could.

Tens of thousands of people donated funds for the Statue of Liberty and her pedestal—including many children. Remind your child(ren) of this and then discuss with them some of the areas/causes where you donate your time or money. For older children, think about engaging them in your annual giving by asking them if there are any areas where they would like to give. They may be interested in causes associated with children, like Stanford Children's Hospital or St. Jude Children's Research Hospital.

GAMES: TRANSPORTING STATUE OF LIBERTY

Liberty was put back together like a giant puzzle.
The statue had been built not once, but twice!

One of the amazing aspects of the history of the Statue of Liberty is how it was built twice, first in France and then in America. You can have some fun simulating this remarkable achievement with the help of a jigsaw puzzle. Ideally the puzzle would feature the Statue of Liberty, however, any puzzle will work.

Our kids love jigsaw puzzles, so this activity works on a couple of levels. First, they enjoy putting the puzzle together. Then, they simulate crossing the Atlantic Ocean and reassembling the puzzle. You can use any barrier in your home as the Atlantic Ocean – a hallway separating rooms, stairs, a carpet. But the idea is that after assembling the puzzle in one location (France), they must transport it in chunks to another location (America), and then reassemble it.

Ask your young engineers to brainstorm multiple ways to transport the "statue" (puzzle) from one "country" to another. Labeling the two locations with the appropriate country helps drive the lesson home.

Younger kids might want to make their own Lady Liberty jigsaw puzzle by coloring a picture of Lady Liberty and then cutting it into just a few pieces to make it easier to "assemble" Lady Liberty in "France" and "America."

